

Asian Paints (NSE: ASIANPAINT)

Volumes are back — but the share price already knows it

18 September 2026 · Analyst: Anay Sharma · Student research · India — Paints & coatings

Investment summary

The recovery is under way. After Grasim launched Birla Opus in early 2024, Asian Paints cut prices and lost product mix: in FY25 decorative volume grew 2.5% but realisation fell about 8%. Volume then grew 9.0% in FY26 and 9.0% again in Q1 FY27.

Pricing power has returned. In Q1 FY27 value growth (16.6%) ran ahead of volume for the first time in over two years, as roughly 10.5–11% of cumulative price increases went through. Price/mix turned positive (+7.0%).

Earnings. Our segment-level driver model, built from the FY26 annual report, takes revenue from ₹35,584 cr (FY26A) to **₹44,321 cr** (FY28E), EBITDA margin from 18.8% to **19.5%** — inside the 18–20% guidance — and EPS from ₹45.1 to **₹60.7**.

Valuation leaves little cushion. At 45x FY28E EPS — a multiple derived from Asian Paints' own P/E history and Berger Paints' current multiple — we reach **₹2,730**, 11% above today's price. A reverse DCF shows the market already implies about 9.1% cash-flow growth in perpetuity.

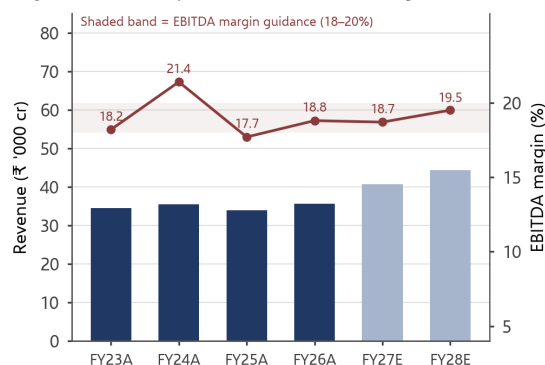
HOLD. The recovery is real, but the price assumes it lasts. The view depends on gross margin holding above roughly 43% and decorative volume staying at or above 8%.

Figure 1: Key financials — earnings recover from the FY25 trough; FY27E–FY28E are estimates

₹ crore unless stated	FY24A	FY25A	FY26A	FY27E	FY28E
Revenue from operations	35,495	33,906	35,584	40,628	44,321
Revenue growth	2.9%	(4.5%)	4.9%	14.2%	9.1%
Gross margin	43.4%	42.4%	43.8%	42.8%	43.5%
EBITDA margin (excl. other income)	21.4%	17.7%	18.8%	18.7%	19.5%
Net profit to owners	5,460	3,667	4,325	5,093	5,823
EPS (₹)	56.9	38.2	45.1	53.1	60.7
P/E at ₹2,454 (x)	43.1x	64.2x	54.4x	46.2x	40.4x
ROE, average equity	31.5%	19.2%	21.2%	—	—

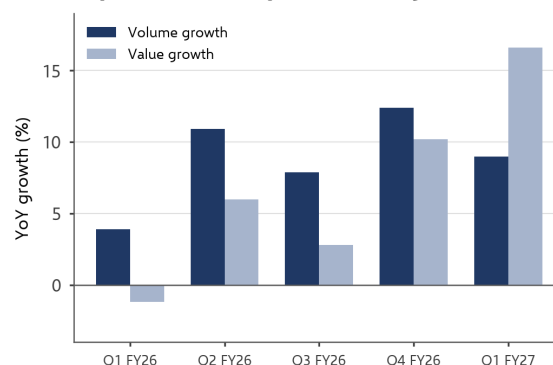
Source: Asian Paints Integrated Annual Reports FY25–FY26 (consolidated statements; Ten-Year Review); FY27E–FY28E author's estimates. FY25–FY26 net profit is after exceptional charges of ₹363 cr and ₹158 cr. EPS uses 95.92 cr shares; company-reported basic EPS is ~₹0.03 higher because it excludes ESOP-trust shares.

Figure 2: Revenue growth resumes; EBITDA margin is expected to stay inside the 18–20% guidance band



Source: Asian Paints IAR FY26 Ten-Year Review; author's estimates (FY27E–FY28E, lighter bars).

Figure 3: Value growth overtook volume growth in Q1 FY27 as price increases passed through



Source: company quarterly results as reported by Business Standard, Angel One and Upstox. Q1 FY26 value = standalone revenue proxy.

What moved the numbers, FY23–FY26

All historical figures in this section are taken from the audited consolidated statements and the Ten-Year Review in Asian Paints' FY25 and FY26 annual reports; FY23 aggregator data was reconciled to the Ten-Year Review totals. Breaking each year into its drivers shows that the three years had **different** causes, which matters for what to expect next.

Figure 4: Earnings bridge — each year had a different driver

Driver	FY24A	FY25A	FY26A	Read-across
Decorative volume growth	10.0%*	2.5%	9.0%	Demand held up even in the worst year
Price/mix (derived)	(5.5%)	(8.0%)	(4.3%)	Three years of giving back price and mix
Gross margin	43.4%	42.4%	43.8%	
change (bp)	474	(96)	135	Raw materials helped FY24 and FY26
Employee + other costs, % of revenue	22.0%	24.7%	25.0%	
change (bp)	152	270	24	FY25 squeeze came from costs, not materials
EBITDA margin (excl. other income)	21.4%	17.7%	18.8%	
change (bp)	322	(366)	111	Net of the two lines above
Exceptional items (₹ cr)	–	(363)	(158)	White Teak, Causeway, Indonesia exit
Net profit growth	33.0%	(32.8%)	17.9%	

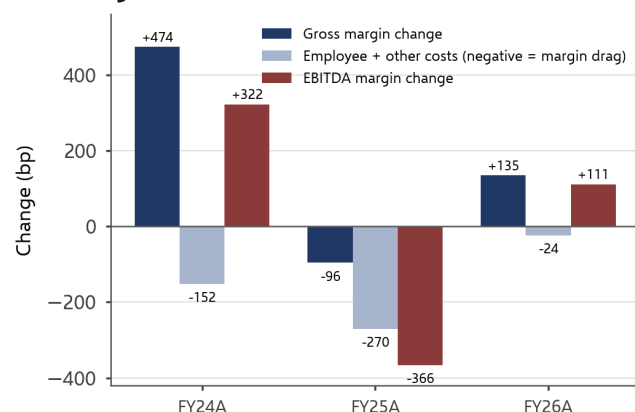
*FY24 volume is decorative + industrial combined (the only figure disclosed). Price/mix is derived: $(1 + \text{value growth}) \div (1 + \text{volume growth}) - 1$; the company does not disclose it. Source: Asian Paints IAR FY25–FY26; results releases (volume/value); author's calculations.

FY24 — the margin peak. Softer crude-linked inputs lifted gross margin by 474bp, but only about two-thirds reached EBITDA because employee and other costs rose 152bp as a share of revenue. Revenue grew just 2.9% on 10% volume as price cuts and down-trading took about 5.5% off realisations.

FY25 — a cost squeeze, not a materials squeeze. This is the most useful finding in the bridge. Gross margin slipped only 96bp; the 366bp fall in EBITDA margin came mostly from operating leverage: revenue fell 4.5% while advertising, distribution and people costs kept rising (+270bp of revenue) as the company defended share against Birla Opus. Management's own letter in the FY25 annual report describes an industry whose revenue ranged from a low-single-digit decline to flat.

FY26 — recovery. Volume grew 9% and value 4.3%; gross margin recovered 135bp on material deflation and sourcing, costs stopped outgrowing revenue, and EBITDA margin rose 111bp to 18.8%. Operating cash flow was ₹7,088 cr, 106% of EBITDA.

Figure 5: Cost deleverage, not raw materials, drove the FY25 margin decline



Source: Asian Paints IAR FY25–FY26; author's calculations (same data as Figure 4).

Reading Figure 5. Dark bars show the change in gross margin, light bars the change in employee and other costs as a share of revenue (shown negative because a rise reduces margin), and red bars the resulting EBITDA margin change. FY24 and FY26 were raw-material years; FY25 was a cost year. That distinction is the basis for the forecast: a recovery in volume and pricing can repair FY25's cost deleverage, but raw-material relief cannot be assumed to repeat with Brent near \$105.

Driver tree used in the forecast

Figure 6: How reported drivers map into the forecast

Level	Driver	Evidence (FY26 unless stated)	Basis
Revenue	Decorative & home décor (86.8%)	₹30,830 cr; +4.3%	Reported
	International (9.4%) · Industrial (3.8%)	₹3,354 cr (+9.4%) · ₹1,332 cr (+12.4%); PPGAP is an associate and excluded	Reported
Decorative	Volume	FY26 9.0%; Q1 FY27 9.0%; FY27 guidance 8–10%	Reported / Guidance
	· industry demand, market share	Industry volume and Asian Paints' share not disclosed; Birla Opus ~10% revenue share (Grasim)	Not disclosed / Secondary
	· rural vs urban	Q1 FY27: rural (T3/T4) ahead of urban; not quantified	Reported (qualitative)
	Realisation (price/mix)	(4.3%) FY26 → 7.0% Q1 FY27; ~10.5–11% cumulative price increases	Derived / Guidance
Gross margin	Raw materials, price, sourcing	43.8%; Q1 FY27 standalone 43.8% vs 45.6% in Q4; Brent ~\$105	Reported / Secondary
	Backward integration	Dahej VAE plant in commercial production from 17-Sep-2026; size of benefit not verified	Reported / Mgmt claim
EBITDA	Employee 7.9%, other 17.1% of revenue	Guidance 18–20% for FY27; advertising split (Note 27) not extracted	Reported / Guidance

Basis: **Reported** = company filing or results release; **Derived** = calculated from reported figures; **Guidance** = management statement; **Secondary** = third-party source; **Assumption** = author's judgement. Source: Asian Paints IAR FY26; results releases; Grasim disclosures.

Competition: structure, not just share

Figure 7: Asian Paints is outgrowing listed peers; Birla Opus is the only fast share-gainer

Metric	Asian Paints	Berger Paints	Kansai Nerolac	Birla Opus (Grasim)
FY26 revenue growth	4.9%	2.9%	2.9%	~100% (doubled)
Q1 FY27 revenue growth	17.9%	12.0%	9.8%	Not disclosed
FY26 EBITDA margin	18.8%	15.4%	12.1%	Not separately disclosed
Decorative share of sales	86.8% (incl. home décor)	Not sourced	Industrial-led; not sourced	~100%
Decorative capacity	2.29 mn KL a year	Not sourced	Not sourced	1,332 MLPA (~24% of industry)
Revenue market share	Not disclosed	Not disclosed	Not disclosed	~10% (Mar-26); +370bp in FY26
Reach	169,000+ touchpoints (FY25)	1,900+ stores	Not sourced	11,500+ towns; 50,000+ dealers
Trailing P/E	49.4x	42.8x	23.1x	Not listed

Source: Asian Paints IAR FY25–FY26 (reported); Grasim releases and FY26 management commentary (competitor disclosure, secondary); Screener for Berger and Kansai (aggregator). Cells marked 'not disclosed' or 'not sourced' have deliberately not been estimated.

Asian Paints is still growing faster than the listed peers, so the pressure is not visible as lost revenue. It is visible in pricing: the only player gaining share quickly is Birla Opus, which already has about a quarter of industry capacity and needs to fill it. Its margins are not disclosed, so how long Grasim will fund price-led growth is the key unknown in this sector.

Quarterly tracker: from recovery to pricing power

The tracker below shows why the thesis changed during the year. Through FY26 the company was buying volume with price: price/mix stayed around (4%) to (5%) for three quarters. In Q4 the gap narrowed to (2%), and in Q1 FY27 it flipped to +7% as price increases passed on crude-linked inflation. That is the single most important data point in this note — but it came with a cost. Standalone gross margin fell 180bp sequentially to 43.8%, and volume (9%) missed the ~12% the Street had expected (management said the channel did not build excess stock, which makes the quarter cleaner). A useful read-across for the model: Q1 FY27 revenue was 25.9% of our FY27E, against 25.1% for Q1 FY26 last year, so our FY27E revenue looks, if anything, slightly conservative.

Figure 8: Quarterly tracker, Q1 FY26 to Q1 FY27 — price/mix turned positive in Q1 FY27

	Q1 FY26	Q2 FY26	Q3 FY26	Q4 FY26	Q1 FY27
Revenue (₹ cr)	8,939	8,531	8,867	9,247	10,542
Revenue growth, YoY	(0.3%)	6.3%	3.7%	10.6%	17.9%
Decorative volume growth	3.9%	10.9%	7.9%	12.4%	9.0%
Decorative value growth	(1.2%)*	6.0%	2.8%	10.2%	16.6%
Implied price/mix	(4.9%)	(4.4%)	(4.7%)	(2.0%)	7.0%
Gross margin	42.7%	43.7% [†]	44.3%	44.8%	43.8% [†]
EBITDA margin (excl. other income)	18.2%	17.6%	20.1%	19.3%	20.6%
Net profit to owners (₹ cr)	1,100	994	1,060	1,172	1,539
Guidance at result	EBITDA 18–20%	High-single-digit volume; mid-single-digit value	EBITDA 18–20%	EBITDA 18–20%; price hikes ~10.5–11%	FY27 volume 8–10%; value > volume
Versus Street	EPS beat	EPS beat	Volume disappointed	PAT well above ₹900–1,000 cr expected	Volume missed ~12% preview; margin beat

[†]Standalone (consolidated not sourced). *Q1 FY26 value growth = standalone revenue proxy. Sum of FY26 quarterly revenue (₹35,584 cr) reconciles to the annual report. Source: company results releases and call commentary as reported by Business Standard, Angel One, Upstox, ICICI Direct, Quartr, FilingReader and GuruFocus (secondary; verification against transcripts pending). 'Versus Street' rows are secondary-source context only and are not used in any calculation.

Forecast: what is fact, guidance and assumption

Figure 9: Base-case forecast assumptions and their anchors

Assumption	FY27E	FY28E	Anchor	Basis
Decorative volume growth	9.0%	8.0%	Guidance 8–10%; Q1 9.0%; FY26 9.0%	Guidance / Assumption
Decorative price/mix	5.0%	1.0%	Q1 +7.0% on ~10.5–11% hikes; H2 laps them; FY24–26 negative	Assumption
International / Industrial growth	12% / 14%	9% / 10%	FY26 9.4% / 12.4%; Q1 FY27 27% / 'mid-teens'	Assumption
Gross margin	42.8%	43.5%	FY26 43.8%; Q1 FY27 SA 43.8% (–180bp QoQ); VAE benefits	Assumption
Employee / other costs, % revenue	7.5% / 16.6%	7.4% / 16.6%	FY26 7.9% / 17.1%; operating leverage on 14% growth	Assumption
EBITDA margin (result)	18.7%	19.5%	Guidance 18–20%; model inside in every year	Calculated
Capex, % revenue	4.5%	4.0%	PPE capex 4.1% FY26, 5.3% FY25	Assumption
Tax rate	26.0%	26.0%	25–28% in FY24–26 (FY25–26 lifted by impairments)	Assumption

Sensitivity (from the model): ±1pp decorative volume in both years ≈ ±₹1.0 FY28E EPS; ±1pp price/mix ≈ ±₹1.0; ±100bp gross margin ≈ ±₹3.4; ±50bp other expenses ≈ ±₹1.7. Gross margin is the variable that matters most. Source: author's estimates; anchors from Asian Paints filings and results commentary.

Revenue is built by segment from the annual-report segment table: decorative & home décor revenue = prior year × (1 + volume) × (1 + price/mix), plus international, industrial and other operating revenue. That gives 14% revenue growth in FY27E (flattered by price increases) and 8–9% after. We expect gross margin to dip about 100bp in FY27E because inputs are linked to crude, and to recover towards 44% by FY30E as backward integration lowers costs; the size of that benefit is a management claim we have not been able to verify. EBITDA margin moves from 18.7% to 19.9% by FY31E. FY27E EPS growth (+18%) is partly mechanical: FY26 profit was reduced by ₹158 cr of exceptional charges.

Balance sheet and cash flow

The balance sheet is a strength. At March 2026 the company had ₹8,135 cr of cash and investments against ₹2,293 cr of borrowings and ₹1,636 cr of lease liabilities — net cash of ₹4,206 cr even after treating leases as debt. Borrowings rose from ₹864 cr to ₹2,293 cr in FY26 to fund capex, according to the company's note on its debt-equity ratio. FY26 free cash flow (operating cash flow less purchases of fixed assets) was ₹5,621 cr, or ₹5,281 cr after ₹340 cr of lease repayments, helped by inventory falling from 72 to 59 days of sales. Returns have stepped down: the company's own ROCE was 39.7% in FY24 and 27.6% in FY26, as profits fell while new plants expanded the capital base.

Figure 10: Cash generation recovered strongly in FY26

₹ crore	FY24A	FY25A	FY26A
Operating cash flow	6,104	4,424	7,088
Capex (purchase of PPE and intangibles)	(2,199)	(1,805)	(1,467)
Free cash flow	3,905	2,619	5,621
Lease principal repaid	(286)	(325)	(340)
Free cash flow after leases	3,619	2,294	5,281
Net cash / (net debt), leases as debt	3,198	3,217	4,206
Inventory days (on revenue)	60.9	72.3	58.9
Company-reported ROCE	39.7%	26.9%	27.6%

Source: Asian Paints IAR FY25–FY26 consolidated cash flow statements and balance sheets (reported); Ten-Year Review (ROCE); free cash flow and net cash are author's calculations.

Valuation: where the 45x comes from

Figure 11: Asian Paints historical P/E

Year-end	Market cap (₹ cr)	PAT (₹ cr)	Trailing P/E	1-yr forward P/E (realised)
Mar-2022	295,428	3,031	97.5x	71.9x
Mar-2023	264,897	4,106	64.5x	48.5x
Mar-2024	273,060	5,460	50.0x	74.5x
Mar-2025	224,232	3,667	61.1x	51.8x
Mar-2026	207,618	4,325	48.0x	–
3-year average / median			53.1x / 50.0x	58.3x / 51.8x
5-year average / median			64.2x / 61.1x	61.7x / 61.9x (4-yr)

Source: Asian Paints IAR FY26 Ten-Year Review (year-end market cap and PAT, reported); P/E author's calculations. Limitation: five year-end snapshots rather than daily averages; FY22 and FY25 are inflated by earnings dips.

Figure 12: Listed peers — Asian Paints trades at a premium on growth and returns

Company	FY26 revenue growth	Q1 FY27 growth	TTM EBITDA margin	EV / EBITDA	P/E (TTM)	ROCE
Asian Paints	4.9%	17.9%	19.5%	32.1x	49.4x	26.3%
Berger Paints	2.9%	12.0%	15.6%	27.2x	42.8x	21.6%
Kansai Nerolac	2.9%	9.8%	12.1%	12.8x	23.1x	12.0%
Indigo Paints	4.2%	18.6%	19.1%	18.5x	31.4x	17.9%

Source: Screener (aggregator), mid-September 2026; ROCE on Screener's basis for comparability (Asian Paints reports 27.6%). Peer forward consensus EPS was not accessed, so forward peer P/E's are not shown rather than estimated.

The multiple is built from evidence rather than chosen to hit a price. Asian Paints' 3-year median year-end P/E is 50x; Berger Paints trades at 43x. The midpoint is 46x, which we round **down** to **45x**. A premium to Berger is justified by faster growth (FY26 4.9% vs 2.9%; Q1 FY27 17.9% vs 12.0%), higher returns (ROCE 26% vs 22%), a wider EBITDA margin and three times the scale. A discount to Asian Paints' own history is justified because returns have fallen and Birla Opus makes FY24-level margins unlikely. Rounding down reflects the current crude-linked pressure on gross margin. We apply the multiple to FY28E because a September 2027 target falls inside FY28.

Why P/E and DCF give different answers

The two methods answer different questions. P/E asks what investors will pay for next year's earnings; it carries the market's long-run assumptions without stating them, and mainly moves with EPS revisions and sentiment ($\pm 5x$ on the multiple moves the target by about ₹300). A DCF asks what the cash flows are worth at an explicit discount rate. With a 10.9% WACC (7.1% risk-free rate, beta 0.7, 5.5% equity risk premium) and 6% terminal growth, our three-stage, 15-year DCF gives ₹1,135 per share — 54% below the market. It is dominated by the gap between WACC and terminal growth: cutting WACC by 1pp and raising terminal growth by 1pp lifts the value by about half.

Figure 13: DCF value per share (₹) — sensitivity to WACC and terminal growth

WACC ↓ / terminal growth →	5.0%	6.0%	7.0%	8.0%
9.5%	₹1,351	₹1,573	₹1,973	₹2,907
10.0%	₹1,213	₹1,377	₹1,651	₹2,199
10.5%	₹1,101	₹1,225	₹1,421	₹1,773
11.0%	₹1,008	₹1,104	₹1,249	₹1,490

Base case: WACC 10.9%, terminal growth 6.0% → ₹1,135. Bold = above the current price of ₹2,454. Stage-2 fade path held at base in the grid. Source: author's calculations; risk-free rate from Trading Economics (secondary); beta and equity risk premium are assumptions.

Working backwards is more useful than the DCF value itself. At today's price the market is implying about **9.1% perpetual growth** at our 10.9% WACC, or an **8.2% WACC** if growth is 6%. In plain terms, the market is treating Asian Paints as a company that will compound close to India's nominal GDP for decades. That may prove right for a category leader in an under-penetrated market, but it means the stock has no valuation cushion. This is why the rating stops at HOLD: the earnings recovery supports modest upside on multiples, while the DCF shows how much is already assumed.

Scenario analysis

Figure 14: Bear / base / bull — inputs (rows 1–3) and outputs

FY28E	Bear	Base	Bull
Decorative volume growth (FY27E / FY28E)	6.0% / 5.0%	9.0% / 8.0%	10.0% / 10.0%
Price/mix (FY27E / FY28E)	3.0% / (1.0%)	5.0% / 1.0%	6.0% / 2.0%
Gross margin (FY28E)	42.0%	43.5%	44.4%
Revenue (₹ cr)	40,480	44,321	46,374
EBITDA (₹ cr)	7,124	8,643	9,692
EBITDA margin	17.6%	19.5%	20.9%
EPS (₹)	49.5	60.7	68.5
Target P/E	40.0x	45.0x	52.0x
Target price (₹)	1,980	2,730	3,560
Upside / (downside) vs ₹2,454	(19.3%)	11.2%	45.1%

Illustrative 25/50/25 weighting gives ₹2,750 (+12%), consistent with HOLD. Source: author's estimates; ranges anchored to FY24–FY26 actuals and FY27 guidance.

Bear — 'FY25 again'. Birla Opus fills its capacity with price-led offers; volume falls below the 8% guidance floor; price increases are partly reversed (price/mix back to (1%) in FY28, as in FY24–26); crude stays above \$100, taking gross margin to about 42%; the market removes the leadership premium (40x, below Berger's 43x). **Base — recovery inside guidance.** Volume of 9% then 8%, price/mix +5% then +1%, a ~100bp gross-margin dip in FY27E that partly reverses, and EBITDA margin inside 18–20%. **Bull — FY24-type margins.** Volume at the top of guidance, most of Q1's +7% price/mix holds, VAE savings lift gross margin to about 44.4% (FY26 standalone level), and the multiple moves to 52x — close to Asian Paints' 3-year median (50x) and the 52x a broker (ICICI Direct) applied in June 2026. The skew is upward in rupees, but the bear case needs only a return to conditions seen as recently as FY25.

Thesis breakers — what would make this view wrong

Figure 15: Signals that would change the view, with evidence-based thresholds

Signal	Threshold	Why this level	Latest
The recovery thesis weakens if...			
Decorative volume growth slows	< 8% for two quarters in a row	Floor of FY27 guidance	9.0% (Q1)
Price/mix turns negative again	< 0%	FY24–FY26 were (4%) to (8%); the thesis rests on the Q1 turn	7.0%
Gross margin fails to hold	< 42.4% for two quarters despite price hikes	FY25 trough	43.8% (SA)
EBITDA margin breaks guidance	< 18% over a half-year	Floor of 18–20% guidance	20.6%
Price is buying revenue at the cost of volume	Volume < 8% while value > 12%	Would mean hikes are hurting demand	9.0% / 16.6%
Birla Opus accelerates	Share gains > 370bp a year with AP volume < 8%	FY26 pace reported by Grasim	~10% share
The valuation view changes if...			
More positive: price falls	≤ ₹2,374 (39x FY28E)	Base target would then imply > 15% upside	₹2,454
More positive: EPS path	Tracking the bull case (₹68.5)	Needs ~44.4% gross margin and ≥ 10% volume	Base ₹60.7
More negative: price rises	≥ ₹3,033 (50x FY28E) without EPS upgrades	Base target would imply > 10% downside	₹2,454

Thresholds are taken from management guidance or past reported results, not chosen for effect. Source: Asian Paints filings and results; Grasim disclosures; author's calculations.

Catalysts and risks

Catalysts: Q2 FY27 results in late October (festive demand; how much of the price increase sticks); gross-margin savings as the Dahej VAE plant ramps up; any easing of crude; Grasim's next disclosure of Birla Opus share. **Downside risks:** crude stays above \$100 and price increases stop covering it; a price war as Birla Opus fills capacity; demand damage from price increases, especially in cities; RBI rate hikes slowing housing and repainting; a broader de-rating of consumer stocks. **Upside risks:** a sharp fall in crude; faster integration savings; rural demand lifting volume above 10%.

Conclusion

The business has turned: volume is growing inside guidance, price/mix is positive for the first time since Birla Opus arrived, and cash generation is strong. The valuation already reflects this. At ₹2,454 the stock trades at about 40x FY28E EPS; at ₹2,374 the implied multiple would fall to about 39x and the base-case target would imply more than 15% upside; at ₹3,033 it would rise to about 50x, where the target implies more than 10% downside. Between those levels, the view depends less on the multiple than on two operating facts to be checked each quarter: whether gross margin holds above roughly 43% as crude-linked costs rise, and whether decorative volume stays at or above 8% after the price increases.

Rating: HOLD, 12-month target ₹2,730.

Sources, methodology and basis of figures

Document	Used for	Source type	Status
Asian Paints IAR FY26 — consolidated financial statements (pp. 459–467)	FY25–FY26 P&L; balance sheet, cash flow, EPS	Company-reported (primary)	Verified
Asian Paints IAR FY26 — Financial Review (pp. 60–63)	Segment revenue; standalone data; key ratios	Company-reported (primary)	Verified
Asian Paints IAR FY26 — Ten-Year Review (pp. 78–79)	FY22–FY26 revenue, material cost, PAT, market cap, ROCE, dividend	Company-reported (primary)	Verified
Asian Paints IAR FY25 — consolidated statements (pp. 440–448)	FY24 P&L; balance sheet, cash flow; FY23 borrowings and leases	Company-reported (primary)	Verified
Asian Paints IAR FY25 — segment page; MD & CEO letter	PPGAP treatment; FY25 industry commentary; retail touchpoints	Company-reported (primary)	Verified
Quarterly results releases and call commentary	Volume/value growth; quarterly margins; guidance	Company disclosure via secondary	Partial
Grasim Industries releases and FY26 commentary	Birla Opus capacity, share, distribution	Competitor disclosure	Partial
Screener.in; MarketsMojo	FY23 balance-sheet and cash-flow lines; peers; share price	Aggregator	To verify
Trading Economics	10-year G-sec yield; Brent	Macro data (secondary)	Partial
ICICI Direct Q4 FY26 result update	Bull-case multiple reference only	Broker	Reference

Basis of figures. Reported: taken directly from a company filing or results release. Derived: calculated by the author from reported figures (e.g. price/mix, free cash flow, net cash, P/E). Guidance: management statements. Assumption: the author's forecast judgements (FY27E onwards, beta, equity risk premium, target multiple). Secondary: third-party reporting of company or market data. Page numbers are from the PDF extracts and should be confirmed against the printed pages.

Corrections made against the filings. Reported EPS (₹45.12, not ₹45.09), total assets (₹34,534 cr, not ₹34,519 cr), lease liabilities, and FY24–FY25 investing cash flows all replaced aggregator figures with audited numbers. The accompanying Excel model contains the full source log (metric, period, value, document, page, source type, verification status), 26 reconciliation and integrity checks (all passing), the assumption log, scenario engine and sensitivities.

Still to verify. FY23 balance-sheet and cash-flow lines (FY24 annual report); quarterly volume/value and gross-margin figures against each investor presentation; the Note 27 split of other expenses (advertising vs freight); peer figures against their own filings; beta.

This note is student research prepared for learning purposes. It is not investment advice.